which cattle, buffalo and pigs were kept. More recent researches by the palaeoclimatologist Dr Dorian Fuller, Dr Ravi Korisettar, Professor of Archaeology at Karnatak University, and Dr P. C. Venkatasubbiah of Dravidian University have further refined Allchin's findings by showing that heavy monsoon rainfall during the Mid-Holocene warm period had greatly encouraged forest growth in the Deccan but had begun to ease off from about 3000 BCE onwards. This had made it possible for nomadic pastoralists to flourish on the Deccan for the first time, soon followed by settled village life and the planned cultivation of crops from about 2400 BCE onwards.[5]

What had further helped determine the later human settlement of the South Indian peninsula was the slowing of the eastward flow of its rivers by the Eastern Ghats. These are more hills than mountains but their elevation is enough to cause the rivers flowing through them to slow, meander and divide, so providing the perfect nurseries for the farming of rice, wheat and pulses.

One of the first to grasp the significance of this drainage system was a remarkable man of many parts named Robert Caldwell, an Ulster Scots Presbyterian whose remains lie beside those of his wife Eliza in the church they and their congregation built at Idaiyangudi, some 30 miles east of Cape Comorin. Caldwell arrived there in 1841, having walked all the way from Madras, and he died there in 1891, after stamping his mark in many other fields beside mission work, including anthropology, archaeology and linguistics. His numerous writings have been called 'pejorative, outrageous, and somewhat paternalistic' by one Indian historian, while another has described his contribution to both the spread of Christianity in South India and the cultural awakening of the region as 'unmatched during the last two hundred years'. He also has a good claim to be